

SEO Current State Analysis — thermofisher.com

Pre-Migration Audit of Homepage and Category Pages

Date: May 4, 2026

Adobe Professional Services – Edge Delivery Services



Table of Contents

SEO Current State Analysis — thermofisher.com 3

1. Executive Summary 3

2. Comparative Overview 3

3. Critical Issues (Site-Wide) 4

4. Heading Hierarchy Issues 5

5. Image SEO Issues 6

6. Link Issues 7

7. Technical Issues 8

8. What's Working Well 8

9. Priority Recommendations 9

10. EDS Migration Auto-Fixes 9

11. Baseline Metrics for Post-Migration Comparison 10

SEO Current State Analysis — thermofisher.com

1. Executive Summary

This analysis audits the current SEO health of thermofisher.com across 4 key pages (homepage + 3 L1 category pages) to establish a baseline before migration to AEM Edge Delivery Services. It identifies systemic issues that should be fixed during migration and highlights what already works well.

Pages Analyzed:

- Homepage: /us/en/home.html
- Antibodies: /us/en/home/life-science/antibodies.html
- Lab Chemicals: /us/en/home/chemicals.html
- Bioprocessing: /us/en/home/bioprocessing.html

2. Comparative Overview

Metric	Homepage	Antibodies	Chemicals	Bioprocessing
H1 Present	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
H1 Text	NONE	"Invitrogen Antibodies"	"Lab Chemicals"	"Bioprocessing Solutions"
Meta Description	Good	Good	Good	Good
Canonical	Correct	Correct	Correct	Correct
OG Image	Broken (URL only)	Custom image	Custom image	Custom image
Hreflang Tags	39	39	39	39
JSON-LD Schema	3 types	None	None	None
Total Resources	111	82	72	69
Images (total)	55	30	37	40
Images without alt	0	12 (40%)	5 (14%)	0 (0%)
Lazy-loaded images	5/55 (9%)	19/30 (63%)	24/37 (65%)	28/40 (70%)
Total links	192	140	149	165
javascript: links	2	2	2	2
Links without text	17	4	7	7
Empty headings	0	7	4	0
Mixed content warnings	No	No	Yes	Yes

3. Critical Issues (Site-Wide)

3.1 No H1 on Homepage

Severity: Critical **Impact:** Google uses H1 as a primary relevance signal. The homepage has zero H1 headings — only H2s (“Featured Education”, “Promotions”, etc.).

Recommendation: Add a clear H1 (can be visually styled to fit design): “Thermo Fisher Scientific — Enabling Healthier, Cleaner, Safer Outcomes”

3.2 user-scalable=0 Blocks Pinch-to-Zoom

Severity: Critical **Impact:** All pages use `maximum-scale=1.0, user-scalable=0` — fails WCAG 2.1 criterion 1.4.4 (Resize Text), penalized by Lighthouse (affects mobile ranking).

Current:

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0, maximum-scale=1.0, user-scalable=0">
```

Should be:

```
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
```

3.3 Zero Structured Data on Category Pages

Severity: Critical **Impact:** Only the homepage has JSON-LD (WebSite, Organization, ItemList). All category pages have zero structured data — no BreadcrumbList schema despite having visual breadcrumbs, no ItemList for product categories.

Missed opportunity: BreadcrumbList schema generates rich snippets in Google SERPs showing navigation path. For a site with 39 locales and thousands of category pages, this is massive lost SERP real estate.

3.4 Excessive Resource Loading

Severity: High **Impact:** Pages load 69–111 network requests including 31 JavaScript files and 12 CSS files. This heavily impacts Core Web Vitals (LCP, TBT, INP) which Google uses as ranking signals since 2021.

Page	Resources	JS Files	Impact
Homepage	111	31	Severe LCP/TBT penalty
Antibodies	82	~25	Major LCP/TBT penalty
Chemicals	72	~22	Significant penalty
Bioprocessing	69	~20	Significant penalty

EDS target: 10–15 resources at LCP, 2 first-party JS files.

3.5 javascript:void(0) Links (All Pages)

Severity: High **Impact:** Every page has 2 `javascript:void(0)` links (cart icon, “Report a Site Issue”). These are not crawlable, waste link equity, and fail accessibility standards.

4. Heading Hierarchy Issues

4.1 Homepage — Missing H1

```
[NO H1]
├── H2: Featured Education
├── H2: Accelerating Science
├── H2: Promotions
└── H2: New products
```

Problem: Flat structure with no primary heading.

4.2 Antibodies — Hidden “Access Denied” H1 + Empty H2s

```
H1: Access Denied          ← HIDDEN, from failed API call
H1: Invitrogen Antibodies ← Actual page heading (2 H1s = bad)
├── H2: (empty)
├── H4: Advanced verification ← Skips H3
├── H2: (empty)
├── H4: Publication-backed performance
├── H2: (empty)
├── H4: Antibody performance guarantee
├── H2: Antibody applications
├── H2: Research areas
├── H2: Related categories
├── H2: Educational content
├── H2: (empty) ×4 more
└── H2: Related pages
```

Problems: - 2 H1 tags (one hidden “Access Denied”) - 7 completely empty H2 tags - H4 used under H2 (skips H3)
- Total of 23 headings, 7 empty

4.3 Chemicals — Inverted H2/H3 Hierarchy

```
H1: Lab Chemicals
├── H2: (empty) ×4
├── H3: Bulk and Custom Chemical Services
├── H3: Applications ← Parent section
│   ├── H2: Building blocks for organic synthesis ← Child is HIGHER than parent
│   ├── H2: Chemicals for clean energy research
│   ├── H2: Small-molecule drug discovery
│   ├── H2: Small-molecule target validation
│   ├── H2: Protecting from PFAS
│   ├── H2: Oligonucleotide synthesis
│   └── H2: Peptide synthesis
├── H3: Resources ← Another parent section
│   ├── H2: Named reactions in organic chemistry
│   ├── H2: Connecting you with brightest minds
│   └── H2: Chemistry resource library
```

Problem: H3 sections contain H2 children — completely inverted. Google interprets H2 as more important than H3, but semantically these are subsections.

4.4 Bioprocessing — H2 Overload (24 H2s)

H1: Bioprocessing Solutions	
— H2: Supporting diverse modalities	← Section heading
— H2: Antibody-Drug Conjugates	← Card title (should be H3)
— H2: Cell Therapy	← Card title
— H2: Gene Therapy	← Card title
— H2: Monoclonal antibodies	← Card title
— H2: Messenger RNA (mRNA)	← Card title
— H2: Vaccines	← Card title
— H2: Bioprocessing solutions designed...	← Section heading
— H2: Bioreactors	← Card title
— H2: Cell Culture Products	← Card title
— H2: Cell Therapy Products	← Card title
— H2: cGMP Chemicals	← Card title
— H2: Chromatography and Purification	← Card title
— H2: Fluid Management	← Card title
— H2: Filtration and Separation	← Card title
— H2: Pharmaceutical Analytics	← Card title
— H2: Single-Use Bioprocessing	← Card title
— H2: Technical services	← Redundant with next
— H2: Strengthen your workflow...	← Same topic as above
— H2: Customers we serve	← Redundant with next
— H2: Supporting biopharma, biotech...	← Same topic as above
— H2: Why choose us?	← Redundant with next
— H2: Built on scale, supply...	← Same topic as above
— H2: Resources	← Section heading
— H3: Bioprocessing Blogs	
— H3: Events and webinars	
— H3: Bioprocessing resources	
— H3: Contact us	

Problems: - 24 H2s flattens the entire page — Google can't distinguish sections from items - Card titles (ADCs, Cell Therapy, etc.) should be H3 under their parent section H2 - Duplicate semantic pairs: "Technical services" / "Strengthen your workflow" say the same thing

5. Image SEO Issues

5.1 Antibodies Page — 40% Missing Alt Text

Stat	Count
Total images	30
Missing alt attribute	12
With alt text	18
Lazy loaded	19

Missing alts include category thumbnails, decorative icons, and application images that should have descriptive text for both accessibility and image search.

5.2 Chemicals Page — 14% Missing Alt Text

Stat	Count
Total images	37
Missing alt attribute	5
With alt text	32
Lazy loaded	24

5.3 Homepage — Poor Lazy Loading

Stat	Count
Total images	55
Missing alt attribute	0
Lazy loaded	5 (9%)

91% of homepage images load eagerly — including below-fold content. Severe unnecessary bandwidth and LCP impact.

5.4 Bioprocessing — Exemplary

Stat	Count
Total images	40
Missing alt attribute	0
With descriptive alt	40
Lazy loaded	28 (70%)

This page demonstrates best practices — 100% alt text coverage with descriptive values and good lazy loading adoption.

6. Link Issues

6.1 Links Without Accessible Text

Links that have no visible text AND no img with alt inside them:

Page	Count	Example
Homepage	17	Promo banner links wrapping only images
Antibodies	4	Icon-only links
Chemicals	7	Category card wrapper links
Bioprocessing	7	Application card wrapper links

Impact: Screen readers announce “link” with no description. Google can’t determine link purpose.

6.2 Non-Crawlable Links

Every page has exactly 2 `javascript:void(0)` links: 1. Cart icon in header 2. “Report a Site Issue” in footer

Impact: These are invisible to Googlebot. The cart should use a proper URL; the feedback link should use a button element.

7. Technical Issues

7.1 Mixed Content (HTTP on HTTPS)

Pages affected: Chemicals, Bioprocessing

Browser console shows mixed content warnings — HTTP resources being loaded on HTTPS pages. Modern browsers may block these resources, and Google may flag the page as partially insecure.

7.2 JavaScript Errors

All pages show console errors: - Cannot read properties of undefined (reading 'quotaExceeded') — storage quota check failing - Identifier 'domain_list' has already been declared — duplicate variable declaration

These indicate broken runtime that may prevent proper structured data injection or analytics firing.

7.3 Hidden “Access Denied” H1 (Antibodies)

A hidden `<h1>Access Denied</h1>` exists in the DOM on the antibodies page — likely from a failed dynamic content fetch. Googlebot renders pages and may see this as the primary heading, potentially impacting relevance signals.

7.4 Content Typo

Chemicals page: “Organometallics and Solvents Organometalloids” — should be “Organometallics and Organometalloids” (missing ‘l’ + incorrect “Solvents” insertion).

8. What’s Working Well

Aspect	Assessment
Title tags	Unique, keyword-rich, consistent {Topic} \ Thermo Fisher Scientific - US format
Meta descriptions	Well-crafted, appropriate length (150–200 chars), keyword-inclusive
Canonical URLs	Self-referencing, correctly set on all pages
Hreflang implementation	Complete 39-locales coverage on every page — rare to see this done correctly
OG images	Custom per-page images (except homepage which is broken)
Category page H1s	Present, descriptive, keyword-targeted
Homepage structured data	WebSite + SearchAction, Organization, ItemList/BlogPosting
Bioprocessing alt text	100% coverage with descriptive values — model for other pages
Lazy loading adoption	60–70% on category pages (good, could be higher)

9. Priority Recommendations

P0 — Fix During Migration (Blocking)

#	Fix	Impact	Effort
1	Add H1 to homepage	Primary ranking signal restored	Trivial
2	Remove <code>user-scalable=0</code> globally	Accessibility compliance + mobile ranking	Trivial
3	Add BreadcrumbList JSON-LD to all category pages	Rich snippets in SERP	Low (auto-generate from breadcrumb block)
4	Fix heading hierarchy (H2 card titles → H3)	Proper document outline for crawlers	Medium (template-level)
5	Remove empty heading tags	Clean document outline	Medium

P1 — Fix During Migration (Important)

#	Fix	Impact	Effort
6	Add alt text to all images (Antibodies: 12, Chemicals: 5)	Accessibility + image search	Low
7	Fix OG image on homepage (currently just domain URL)	Social sharing previews	Trivial
8	Remove hidden "Access Denied" H1	Prevent mis-indexing	Low
9	Fix mixed content (HTTP → HTTPS)	Security indicators, resource loading	Low
10	Increase lazy loading on homepage (currently 9%)	LCP improvement	Low (EDS handles automatically)

P2 — Fix During Migration (Nice to Have)

#	Fix	Impact	Effort
11	Replace <code>javascript:void(0)</code> with proper elements	Crawlability + accessibility	Low
12	Add accessible text to image-only links	Screen reader UX + link equity	Low
13	Fix content typo ("Organometalics")	Professionalism	Trivial
14	Remove duplicate/redundant heading pairs (Bioprocessing)	Cleaner outline	Low
15	Add ItemList schema for product categories	Enhanced SERP display	Medium

10. EDS Migration Auto-Fixes

The following issues are automatically resolved by migrating to Edge Delivery Services:

Current Problem	EDS Solution
111 resource requests	EDS: 5–10 resources at LCP
31 JavaScript files (jQuery, jQuery Migrate)	EDS: 2 first-party JS files, zero dependencies
Poor lazy loading (9% homepage)	EDS auto-lazy-loads all below-fold images
user-scalable=0 in viewport	EDS default viewport doesn't restrict zoom
Render-blocking CSS (12 files)	EDS: 1 critical CSS file + lazy-styles.css
Mixed content warnings	EDS serves everything over HTTPS by default
Empty heading tags from AEM components	EDS blocks render clean semantic HTML
Flat H2 hierarchy from parsys	EDS section/block model enforces proper nesting

11. Baseline Metrics for Post-Migration Comparison

Metric	Homepage	Antibodies	Chemicals	Bioprocessing
Title	Thermo Fisher Scientific - US	Antibodies TFS - US	Lab Chemicals TFS - US	Bioprocessing Solutions TFS - US
Description length	159 chars	161 chars	199 chars	191 chars
H1 count	0	2 (1 hidden)	1	1
H2 count	4	16 (7 empty)	18 (4 empty)	24
H3 count	0	0	3	4
JSON-LD count	3	0	0	0
Hreflang count	39	39	39	39
Total images	55	30	37	40
Images without alt	0	12	5	0
Total links	192	140	149	165
Network requests	111	82	72	69

These baselines should be compared against post-migration crawl data to verify zero regression.